

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Deccan network polity and route frame

SATAVAHANA POWER

- |-- plateau agrarian zones + Godavari-Krishna corridors
- |-- Naneghat and western passes -> Konkan ports
- |-- aharas and royal officers -> local administration
- |-- maharathis / mahabhojas -> negotiated regional authority
- `-- merchants + Brahmanas + Buddhist institutions -> legitimacy

VERDICT: a strong but uneven network polity, not uniform peninsular bureaucracy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Evidence hierarchy and chronology

PURANIC LISTS -> genealogy and broad sequence -> redaction limits

INSCRIPTIONS -> rulers, donors, offices and claims -> prashasti limits

COINS -> names, metals, overstrikes and circulation -> borders remain uncertain

ARCHAEOLOGY -> towns, caves, stupas and crafts -> attribution varies

CLASSICAL TEXTS -> routes and commodities -> external perspective

METHOD: converge sources; use ranges rather than one exact dynastic chronology.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Early rulers, Satakarni and Naneghat

SIMUKA -> conventional founder; date and first core debated

KANHA -> early western Deccan inscriptional presence

SATAKARNI I + NAGANIKA

- |-- Naneghat genealogy and portrait memory

- |-- Vedic sacrifices and royal status claims

- `-- route-pass location converts mobility into political display

CAUTION: ritual language and portraits prove claims, not complete territorial maps.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Multi-centred political geography

PRATISHTHANA / PAITHAN -> western-central dynastic anchor

NASHIK / JUNNAR / NANEGhat -> passes, caves, donors and conflict zone

TAGARA / TER -> inland market network

KRISHNA-GODAVARI -> Dharanikota-Amaravati and eastern centres

LOCAL CORES SHIFT ACROSS REIGNS AND RIVALRIES

RULE: capitals and coin finds identify nodes; they do not prove equal direct control.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Administration and local elites

KING / MOBILE COURT

- |-- ahara territorial units
- |-- amatya, mahamatra and mahasenapati offices
- |-- revenue, grants, warfare and route protection
- |-- maharathi / mahabhoja / local ruling families
- `-- village, guild, monastery and donor networks

RESULT: royal capacity worked through layered authority and local intermediaries.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Kshatrapa conflict and Gautamiputra

WESTERN PORTS + PASSES + MALWA-DECCAN ROUTES

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SATAVAHANA <-> WESTERN KSHATRAPA RIVALRY

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Nahapana expansion -> Gautamiputra counter-expansion

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Nashik prashasti: royal victory and social-ideological claims

LIMIT: Gautami Balashri's eulogy must be checked against coins and regional evidence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Nahapana overstrikes as evidence

NAHAPANA SILVER COINS

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GAUTAMIPUTRA OVERSTRIKES

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secure sequence of displacement / metal reuse in a conflict context

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supports restoration of authority in selected western zones

DOES NOT PROVE: one-day conquest, total destruction or unchanged borders afterward.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Agrarian expansion and land grants

IRON + CLEARANCE + PADDY / COTTON + WATER MANAGEMENT

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expanding agrarian production

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royal grants -> rights, exemptions and religious beneficiaries

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new settlements + fiscal reallocation + local authority

DEBATE: grants aided expansion and legitimation; effects differed by place and date.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Crafts, guilds, towns and trade

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VILLAGE RAW MATERIALS -> CRAFT CLUSTERS -> INLAND TOWNS
|           |           |
cotton / metal   guild bodies   Paithan / Tagara
|           |           |
\-----> passes and markets ----->
              western/eastern ports
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EVIDENCE: cave donors, deposits, coins, Periplus and excavated settlements.

LIMIT: connectivity was extensive but neither uniform nor wholly state-controlled.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Society, matronymics and women

VARNA IDEOLOGY -> royal claims and Brahmanical legitimation

SOCIAL PRACTICE -> merchants, artisans, cultivators and local elites

MATRONYMICS -> Gautamiputra, Vasisthiputra and lineage identification

ROYAL WOMEN -> Naganika and Gautami Balashri as inscriptional actors

DONOR WOMEN -> visible in cave and religious patronage

VERDICT: female agency was real but operated within unequal patriarchal structures.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Religion, language, caves and Amaravati

BRAHMANICAL RITES + Prakrit royal inscriptions

BUDDHIST CAVES -> Nashik, Karla and Junnar donor-route landscapes

AMARAVATI -> long stupa, sculpture and patronage sequence

MERCHANTS + ARTISANS + WOMEN + RULERS -> plural donor field

GATHA SATTASAI tradition -> literary memory with attribution cautions

RULE: plural patronage joined belief, legitimacy, routes and social visibility.

ASCHII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Decline, legacy and answer spine

LATER RULERS + REGIONAL SUCCESSORS + SHIFTING ROUTES

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contraction and fragmentation, not instant disappearance

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LEGACIES: Deccan state forms, grants, Prakrit epigraphy, caves and trade nodes

WRITE: thesis -> chronology/source -> polity -> economy -> society/culture

-> one debate -> graded verdict

FINAL: integration was durable, but sovereignty and prosperity remained uneven.